

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦Q

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣K

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥4

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣K

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 7 3

♥ 10 2

♦ 9 6 3

♣ 10 9 5 3

♠ K 9

♥ A K J 6 5

♦ A 10 5

♣ A 7 6



♠ J 6 5 4

♥ 9 7

♦ Q J 8 2

♣ J 8 4

♠ Q 8 2

♥ Q 8 4 3

♦ K 7 4

♣ K Q 2

NORTH has 20 points, a pretty strong hand to open 1♥.

SOUTH has 12 points, and makes a Limit Raise, a jump to 3♥.

NORTH is very, very close to bidding a slam. But she knows SOUTH has 12 points at most, so she should take the safe position and just bid 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♦Q

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 8 7 4 2

♥ K Q 3

♦ 8 6

♣ 9 5

♠ 10

♥ A 8 6 4

♦ K J 9 3

♣ Q 10 8 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 6 5 3

♥ J 10 9

♦ A Q 5 4

♣ 6

♠ K

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A K J 4 3 2

West

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♣K

North

Pass

East

1♠

South

Pass

WEST passes to start with since he only has 9 points.

EAST naturally opens 1♠ with her 13 point, 5-card ♠ suit hand.

WEST might now make a Limit Raise since his hand is now worth 11 points because of the two doubletons. However, with six trumps he should jump all the way to 4♠.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 4
♥ 8 6 4 3
♦ J 7 5 2
♣ A 8 4

♠ J 10 8 2

♥ K 5 2

♦ 8 6

♣ Q 7 6 3



♠ 6

♥ A J 10 9

♦ Q 10 9 4

♣ J 10 9 5

♠ A Q 9 7 5 3

♥ Q 7

♦ A K 3

♣ K 2

SOUTH has 20 points, counting two extra for the fifth and sixth ♠s. Naturally she opens 1 ♠.

NORTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. He has four of partner's ♠s so he responds 2 ♠.

SOUTH KNOWS that $6 + 20 = 26$, so she GOES to 4 ♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ 4			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ A J 8 7 2
♦ K Q J
♣ A 3

♠ Q 6 5

♥ 6 3

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K Q J 8 5



♠ J 8

♥ K Q 5 4

♦ 9 7 5 3

♣ 10 6 4

♠ K 10 9 3 2

♥ 10 9

♦ A 10 4

♣ 9 7 2

WEST has 20 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♥ rather than 2NT.

EAST barely has enough points for a response, but she does have four ♥s. So she responds 2♥.

WEST adds EAST's 6 to his 20 and bids the game, 4♥.

West

1♥

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

Lead: ♣K

North

Pass

East

2♥

South

Pass